

Men's fashion

The style of Western men's clothing, hair, and accessories changes as fast as women's fashion. Even centuries ago men were obsessed with fashion and loved to wear stylish clothes. They often spent more on clothes than women did.

2ND CENTURY BCE

THE ROMANS

Ancient Rome had strict clothing rules. Roman senators, part of the government, were at the highest level of society – they wore tunics called togas, and sandals.



ROMAN TOGA

BROOCH TO HOLD ROBE IN PLACE



STUDDED SANDALS

5TH CENTURY CE

MEDIEVAL

Rich young men could become knights. They wore metal armour over their legs, while on top they wore a shirt made from metal mesh, called chain-mail. This made it easier for the knight to move and protected him from stab wounds.

LACE-UP CHAIN-MAIL



1550s

COURT STYLE

The kings of Europe set the trends, wearing new fabrics such as silk from China and Iraq, and cotton from India and Egypt. Clothes came in new colours, too, such as scarlet-red, as exotic dyes were imported from around the world.



PLUS FOURS AND KNITTED VEST

1930s

ELEGANCE

Men dressed to show off their upper body, wearing jackets with padded shoulders and wide lapels to give the illusion of a strong chest. The athletic look was in fashion, so men took up sport to get in shape.



SWIMMING COSTUME



FEDORA HAT



PLUS FOURS AND POLO SHIRT



BAGGY SUIT

1920s

THE ROARING TWENTIES

Sport was the new trend, so many men dressed in a more casual style, ready for cycling, golf, tennis, athletics, and dancing. Short trousers called plus fours were a popular new fashion.



KNICKERBOCKERS WITH ARGYLE SOCKS



OPEN SUMMER SHOES



BROGUES



STRIPED ENAMEL CUFFLINKS



STRAW BOATER



TWEED CAP



ATHLETIC WEAR

1940s

THE FORTIES

There were not many clothes for sale during World War II, as producing food and weaponry was more important. Men made do with fewer suits and dressed simply, although shoes and hats were still key accessories.



CASUAL ATTIRE



BAGGY TROUSER SUIT



TRILBY HAT



AVIATOR SUNGLASSES



SPECTATOR SHOES

1950s

SMART CASUAL

After years of wearing military uniforms, men wanted to relax and wear more casual clothes. Pinstripe, double-breasted suits were popular, and so were shorter Italian-style jackets. Young men developed their own style, and jeans were especially fashionable.



HOMBURG HAT



SUEDE SHOES WITH CREPE SOLES



LEATHER JACKET



COWBOY JEANS



FORMAL SUIT

1960s

THE NEW DANDIES

Young men wanted to show off and stand out. They wore slim, ankle-length trousers or jeans with tight-fitting shirts or sweaters. Pop music was a big influence on fashion and hairstyles.



LEATHER COAT, SLIM TROUSERS



BEATLES-STYLE SUNGLASSES



POINTED SHOES